

thing I could not do, is use an older backup of the registry, as I'd just taken the backup that very day. I tried it out though, but it didn't help.

Kaisar

▲ This error is caused by an incompatible version of a DLL that was installed on the system, such as Oleaut32.dll, Olepro32.dll, Asycfilt.dll, or Stdole2.tlb. For example, version 3.50 of Oleaut32.dll is installed and used only by Windows XP. So, you get this error if it is installed on a machine running any other operating system.

There are three fixes you can try. Choose the appropriate for your computer:

If you have Microsoft Office or an Office 2000 component installed, install the Office 2000 Service Release 1. You can use this solution for any operating system.

If you do not have Office 2000 or an Office 2000 component installed, download and install the mcrepair.exe tool from <http://download.microsoft.com/download/msninvestor/patch/1.0/win98/en-us/mcrepair.exe>. When it prompts you to overwrite newer files, make sure you click 'Yes' for each file. You can use this solution for any operating system.

If you're using Windows 98 or 95, the error is due to a bad version of

oleaut32.dll. To correct this problem, follow these directions to remove the old file and reinstall it. First, download the file appropriate to your operating system to your desktop, but do not execute it. The download locations are:

For Windows 98: <http://support.installshield.com/kb/files/Q108188/dcom98.exe>

For Windows 95: <http://support.installshield.com/kb/files/Q108188/dcom95.exe>

Now go to **Start > Shutdown > Restart in MS-DOS mode**. At the command prompt, enter the following commands on separate lines as shown:

```
CD c:\windows\system
rename oleaut32.dll oleaut32.old
exit
```

Now Windows will restart. Ignore the error message: "A required .DLL file, C:\windows\system\oleaut32.dll, was not found." Double-click the file you downloaded to your Desktop earlier. Click Yes at the dialog that opens. The dcom.exe file installs a new oleaut32.dll file. After DCOM has been installed, restart the system.

If this procedure results in your PC getting even worse, simply go back to the MS-DOS prompt, and rename the oleaut32.old file back to oleaut32.dll.

You're mistaken, mister

User discipline

Q I have five PCs running Windows 2000 Professional connected over a LAN. I created user accounts with group membership as Guests so as to prevent users from installing software without my permission, though they should be able to download software, MP3s, video, etc. However, users can still install software at will. I run a cyber café, and it's really difficult to spy on each and every person who walks in.

Hari

▲ If your file system is NTFS, then the simplest way about it is to provide write permission for the entire C: drive to the administrator only. Right-click the C: drive, select Security, and here remove all groups with the exception of the Administrators group. Check the 'Inherent to sub-folders' checkbox,

Illustrations: Mahesh Benkar

and press OK to set the new permission. Now, the guest user won't be able to install any software. Next, create a common folder wherein users can download software. This folder should have read and write permissions for all, and can be on the C: drive or any other partition. Alternatively, you can get the users to download software onto a floppy disk.



Q You gave the Linux version of DOOM in the previous CD, but I'm new to Linux, and don't know how to install it on Red Hat Linux 9.0.

Hira Nand Prasad

▲ The version of DOOM supplied on the CD in the February issue is neither for Windows nor for Linux. It's for a Mobile, i.e., the Symbian Platform. It's a Java-based application; you need to attach the mobile phone to the computer, and transfer the application to the mobile, in order to use it. But this version is meant only for the Symbian platform, so you'll be able to use it only if you have a mobile running the Symbian OS.

I need a service centre

Q I stay near Charni Road, Mumbai. Could you please recommend a good service centre or technician who won't insist on me signing a yearly contract to make home visits?

My system is three years old, and it's been showing the wrong time for the past two months. I believe this problem can be solved by replacing the CMOS battery. But according to my vendor—my system is assembled—this is a crystal oscillator problem. Is that true? Can a motherboard fault cause the wrong time to show up in the system tray?

I've not signed a yearly contract with my vendor, so he won't send a technician for inspection of the fault.

Ashar Bhavesh

▲ Firstly, sorry: We can't recommend any company or individuals to you. But regarding the CMOS battery, you can boot your machine without the CMOS battery. The only difference would be that the machine will generate a CMOS checksum error, and you would have to press **[F1]** each time you restart. Also, if CMOS battery is at fault, it will not be able to retain the changes made to the time.

Replacing the battery is not difficult. Open the cabinet, locate the old battery, remove it, and insert the new one. A CMOS battery costs around Rs 20. If the problem is not rectified after replacing the battery, then it might be due to the oscillator, in which case you'll have to take the motherboard to a service centre.

Windows Explorer keeps crashing